Dump truck maintenance schedule

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For medium-duty dump trucks, the F-550 to F-750, Isuzu NPR, Ram 5500 and International MV class.
Dump work is severe duty almost by definition: idling, low speeds, heavy loads and dust. So use the severe schedule, and track engine hours as well as miles.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your truck's manual and its oil-life monitor come first. Your dump body and hoist maker's manual covers the body.

Every day

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Check hoist oil level	Daily	Park level and cycle the hoist empty a few times first	
Hoist oil looks clean	Daily	Milky, dark or thin oil gets changed right away	
PTO off before driving	Every time		
Tailgate unlocked to dump, locked after	Every dump		
Body prop in place before anyone works under a raised body	Every time		
Air brakes: drain the air tanks	Daily	Air brake trucks only, or check the auto drains work	

Weekly and monthly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Inspect hydraulic hoses	Weekly	Replace worn ones right away	
Check nuts, bolts, cotter pins and control linkage	Weekly		
Drain the fuel water separator	Monthly	Right away if the water-in-fuel light comes on	
Grease hoist pivots, hinge pins, tailgate hinges and latches	About every 150 dumps or 2 months	Whichever comes first	

Engine and chassis (severe duty)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Engine oil and filter	Per your engine, on the severe schedule	Often around 250 to 350 engine hours or 5,000 to 12,000 miles; use hours if the truck idles a lot	
Fuel filters	Every other oil change (severe)	Per your manual	
Air filter	Check the restriction gauge each oil change		
Coolant strength	About every 15,000 miles or 600 hours		
Lube king pins and the front end	Every service		
Coolant, brake fluid replacement	Per your manual	Often every 2 years on some trucks	

Yearly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Change the hoist hydraulic oil	Yearly	Sooner with heavy use or dust	
Clean the hoist reservoir breather	Each hoist oil change		
Adjust tailgate latches	As needed		

Required by code? If the truck is a commercial motor vehicle (most dump trucks are), federal or state rules may require a yearly inspection, written maintenance records and daily inspection reports. See the daily truck inspection checklist for who that applies to. Requirements vary by state, so check with yours.

Service log: dump truck

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	MILES / HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS